



# National University

of Computer and Emerging Sciences

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------|------------------|
| <b>Department</b>                                                                                        |                                                      | Computer Science                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Dept. Code</b>     | CS         |                  |
| <b>Course Title</b>                                                                                      |                                                      | Functional English                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Course Code</b>    | SS1012     |                  |
| <b>Pre-requisite(s)</b>                                                                                  |                                                      | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Credit Hrs.</b>    | 2+1        |                  |
| <b>Course Objective:</b>                                                                                 |                                                      | The course will acquaint students with more concise, lucid, and correct expression of English. The aims are to: achieve proficiency in language use, develop skills in reading comprehension, improve reading efficiency, use the conventions of standard written English with skill and assurance, build-up vocabulary, and summarize clearly and accurately the ideas of others etc. It will illustrate the force and effectiveness of simple and direct English. The course is intended to be interesting in itself. |                       |            |                  |
| <b>PLO</b>                                                                                               | <b>Program Learning Outcome (PLO) Statement</b>      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                       |            |                  |
| 10                                                                                                       | Communication                                        | Communicate effectively on complex computing activities with the computing community and with society at large.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                       |            |                  |
| 12                                                                                                       | Life-long Learning                                   | Recognize the need for, and have the preparation and ability to engage in independent and life-long learning in the broadest context of technological changes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                       |            |                  |
| <b>CLO</b>                                                                                               | <b>Course Learning Outcome (CLO)</b>                 | <b>Domain</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Taxonomy Level</b> | <b>PLO</b> | <b>Tools</b>     |
| 01                                                                                                       | Demonstrate effective academic writing style         | Cognitive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2                     | 10         | <b>CPA, M</b>    |
| 02                                                                                                       | Plan their ideas and build effective essay outlines. | Cognitive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 3                     | 10         | <b>A, M, CPA</b> |
| 03                                                                                                       | Construct academic essays on variety of topics       | Cognitive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 3                     | 12         | <b>FP, F</b>     |
| <i>Tool: A = Assignment, M = Midterm, F=Final, CPA =Class Participation Activity ,FP = Final Project</i> |                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                       |            |                  |

|                     |                  |                            |
|---------------------|------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Text Book(s)</b> | <b>Title</b>     | College Writing Skills     |
|                     | <b>Author</b>    | John Langan                |
|                     | <b>Publisher</b> | McGraw Hill                |
| <b>Ref. Book(s)</b> | <b>Title</b>     | Oxford Practice Grammar    |
|                     | <b>Author</b>    | John Eastwood              |
|                     | <b>Publisher</b> | Oxford University Press    |
|                     | <b>Title</b>     | English Vocabulary in use  |
|                     | <b>Author</b>    | Michael McCarthy           |
|                     | <b>Publisher</b> | Cambridge University Press |

| Weeks | Contents/Topics                                                                                                   | CLOs |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 1     | Orientation Class. Characteristics of Formal Writing;                                                             | 1    |
| 2     | Written English- Phrases, Clauses                                                                                 | 1    |
| 3     | Conjunctions: Subordinating, Coordinating, and Co relative                                                        | 1    |
| 4     | Common Sentential Errors: Fragments, Run-ons, Subject Verb Agreement                                              |      |
| 5     | Introduction to Academic Writing. The Writing Process.                                                            | 2    |
| 6     | <b>Midterm 1</b>                                                                                                  |      |
| 7     | Writing Process and Making Informational Essay Outlines                                                           | 2    |
| 8     | Types of Paragraphs- The Body Paragraph <b>Assignment 1: Writing Process and Body Paragraph (Deadline:week 9)</b> | 2    |
| 9     | Writing Introduction Paragraph                                                                                    | 2    |
| 10    | Writing Conclusion Paragraph                                                                                      | 1    |
| 11    | Revision: Unity, Coherence, and Development of Ideas. Editing.                                                    | 3    |
| 12    | <b>Midterm 2</b>                                                                                                  |      |
| 13    | Compare and Contrast Essay                                                                                        | 3    |
| 14    | Argumentative Essay <b>Assignment 2: Argumentative or Compare and Contrast Essay (Deadline week:15)</b>           | 3    |
| 15    | Problem Solution Essay <b>Project: Scenario on Week 15 topics (Deadline: week 16)</b>                             | 3    |
| 16    | Revision                                                                                                          |      |

#### Assessment

| Particulars      | % Marks    |
|------------------|------------|
| 1. Assignments   | 7%         |
| 2. Quizzes       | 8%         |
| 3. Final Project | 5%         |
| 4. Mid-Terms     | 30 %       |
| 5. Final Exam    | 50 %       |
| <b>Total:-</b>   | <b>100</b> |

Invite your teacher/friend to the celebration of your recent achievement.

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I am delighted to invite you to celebrate my recent achievement. Your support and guidance have been invaluable, and it would mean a lot to me to have you join the celebration.



# UNDERSTANDING THE FEATURES OF FORMAL WRITING

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Ms. Javeriya Ahmed Hussain

# Key Features

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Well-  
Planned

Syntactic  
Complexity

Standard  
Grammar

Formal  
Vocabulary

Well-  
Organized

Use of  
Punctuations

Delayed  
Feedback

No Short  
Forms

Impersonal  
Language

Learnt Craft

# 1) Well-Planned



Not spontaneous like regular conversations.

Follow the writing process.

Planned, composed, revised, and edited before it reaches the audience.



## 2) Syntactic Complexity

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- Well-formed and refined sentences.
- Connectors and conjunctions are important to make writing compact and not repetitive.



### 3) Standard Grammar

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- Follow grammar rules strictly.
- Any grammatical mistake can lead to misunderstanding.

Only I learn German language.  
I learn German language only.



## 4) Formal Vocabulary

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- Uses dignified vocabulary.
- It avoids the usage of idioms and phrasal verbs

*Informal*

**Formal**

**Sorry**



**Apologize**

**Tell**



**Inform**

**Need**



**Require**

**Ask**



**Request**

**Check**



**Verify**

**Get**



**Receive**

## 5) Well Organized

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- Written message must be well-structured and organized.
- Well- formed sentences & paragraphs.
- Format of a given written document such as a letter, essay, etc. must also be followed properly for clarity

## 6) Use of Punctuations:

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- Speakers use their voices (pitch, rhythm, stress), pauses, intonation and their bodies to communicate their message
- Punctuation marks, underlining, capitals, and connectors can be used to represent pauses, emphasis, tone, etc.

Let's eat, Grandma!

Let's eat Grandma!

## 7) Delayed Feedback:

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- Immediate feedback in the form of verbal (questions, comments, grunts) and non- verbal tools (facial expressions, body language).
- Writer may have to anticipate the reader's feedback and incorporate it into the text.

## 8) No contractions:

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- Formal writing avoids abbreviations and short forms.
- It uses formal and well-known acronyms or abbreviation usually after using the full form first and then informing the reader that the writer will use the short form in the future.

## 9) Impersonal Language

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- Avoid the use of personal pronouns such as “I”, “we” and even “you”.

## 10) Learnt Craft

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- Formal writing is a learnt skill and essential for both academic and professional success.

# Exercise 1: Change to the 3rd person.

1. My essay will cover four main areas.

2. You need to take all factors into consideration.

3. We should monitor the results more closely.

4. In my opinion, the evidence seems flawed.

5. I will challenge this idea in my essay.

6. If you want to improve writing, you need to practise a great deal.

7. We feel that the government should take action.

8. When you go to college, you must organise your time effectively.

9. I do not agree with this solution.

10. If we want to help the situation, we could raise money.



## Exercise 2: Change to a passive.

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1. Because of snow, the Principal has closed the college.
2. The teacher cancelled the classes.
3. Someone has called an election.
4. We should not ban smoking.
5. The government raises money from taxation

Exercise 3: Complete the transformation of these sentences so there are not as many simple/compound sentences, and link ideas better.

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She studied history at university. This was in Edinburgh. She now teaches at a London school. There are many different nationalities, cultures and religions. She likes the job. She finds discipline can be a problem.

## Exercise 4: Change the underlined sentences/verbs to nouns, making any other changes as necessary.

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1. This essay will discuss how much this option will cost.
2. It was difficult to understand what he meant.
3. This essay will discuss why the accident happened.
4. This essay will discuss how fast the Internet grew.
5. The report looked at how large the population was.

## Exercise 5: Read the following paragraph and revise for formal vocabulary.

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Hey guys! So, global warming is like a big deal nowadays. The planet's heating up 'cause of all the nasty stuff we're pumping into the air. It's messing with the weather, causing crazy storms and making the ice melt like mad. This ain't good for us or the animals. We gotta step up and fix this mess by using less gas and being more green. If we don't, things are gonna get way worse. Can you help make this sound more formal?

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# Homework

# Exercise 1: Change direct questions to indirect questions/sentences.

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1. What are the consequences of high inflation?
2. How can we tackle this problem?
3. Is this new law needed?
4. Does continuous assessment put too much pressure on students?
5. Should grants replace loans?

## Exercise 2: Rewrite the following paragraphs and make them formal

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Alright, folks, let's talk tourism! Ya ever think about why tourism's such a big deal? I mean, c'mon, it's like the lifeblood of so many places. It brings in dough, creates jobs, and man, it's a real game-changer for local businesses. Think about it – hotels, restaurants, shops – they all get a piece of the pie when tourists roll into town. Plus, it's not just about the cash flow. Tourists bring in new ideas, cultures, and vibes that mix things up a bit. Ever been to a place and thought, “Wow, I've gotta tell everyone about this”? That's the magic of tourism, folks! It's a win-win – you get your adventure, and the locals get to show off their turf. And hey, who doesn't love a good story about their travels? So, what's the big deal about tourism? It's like a breath of fresh air for the economy and culture, boosting various sectors like entertainment, transportation, etc.